Yoga and diabetes mellitus

Practice of Pranayama produces a significant fall in the fasting blood sugar and post prandial blood sugar. Blood pressure is maintained at normal levels with significant reduction in the dosage requirement of antihypertensive. A significant decrease in LDL and VLDL with increase in HDL cholesterol is noted after the practice of yoga in diabetic individuals.



Women who watch twenty hours or more of television each week are more likely to experience obesity, diabetes and other health risks. Researchers found that every two hours spent on watching television was associated with a 14 percent increase in diabetes risk.

9.7.5. Education

The Diabetics should be educated on the nature of the disease they have and the possibility of development of acute and long term complications of the disease if the blood sugar is not kept under control. Adequate basic information on diabetes enables the diabetic to comprehend and improve their psychological acceptance of the disease. In addition, the importance of following the Doctor's and Dietitian's instructions regarding diet, drugs and exercise should be explained.

Diabetics should be aware of the importance of monitoring urine and blood sugar and serum lipids at regular intervals to ensure overall wellbeing. Diabetics should understand the principles of dietary modifications and comply. Diabetics should be aware of complications and preventing methods.



Metabolic syndrome is a cluster of several medical conditions or comorbidities namely central (visceral) obesity, hypertension, insulin resistance and abnormal lipid metabolism which together increase the risk of type 2 Diabetes mellitus and cardiovascular diseases. A person is designated as having the metabolic syndrome if he or she has three of the following abnormalities:

- Abdominal obesity
- Prediabetes
- High blood pressure
- Low serum HDL cholesterol
- Elevated serum triglycerides

9.8. Complications of Diabetes

9.8.1. Acute complications

Hypoglycaemia: This is a condition of low glucose in the blood stream which can be caused by:

- ❖ An overdose of insulin
- ❖ Omission of food
- ❖ Loss of food by vomiting or diarrhoea
- ❖ Increase in exercise without accompanying modification of insulin dosages

Patient experiencing hypoglycaemia becomes uneasy, nervous, restless, weak and hungry. They appear pale and the skin becomes moist with excessive perspiration. There may be trembling, dizziness and double vision. Nausea or vomiting and convulsions can occur. If untreated, it may lead to coma and death.

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